INTRODUCTION TO ISLAM

SAEEDA PARSA

Lecturer Islamic Studies & Arabic

DIHPE - Dow University of Health Sciences (DUHS)

DOW UNIVERSITY of HEALTH SCIENCES

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LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ✓ Students will explore the deeper philosophical meaning behind the term "Islam" and how it signifies submission to Allah.
- ✓ Students will list and explain the six core beliefs (Iman) central to Islamic faith, including belief in Allah, angels, prophets, holy books, the Day of Judgment, and divine destiny (Qadr).
- ✓ Students will discover the detailed faith statement of Iman-e-Mufassil, its significance in Islamic belief, and how it differs from the concise Iman-e-Mujmal.
- ✓ Students will study the concept of prophethood, its role in Islam, and the characteristics of a prophet.
- ✓ Students will describe the concept of life after death, accountability, and the events of the Day of Judgment in Islamic teachings.

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parsa.rafiq@duhs.edu.pk

WHAT WE DISCUSS

- Definition of Islam
- Meaning of Islam
- Its core beliefs
- Iman e Mufassil
- Key theological concepts and themes (Tawhid, Prophethood, Akhirah etc.)



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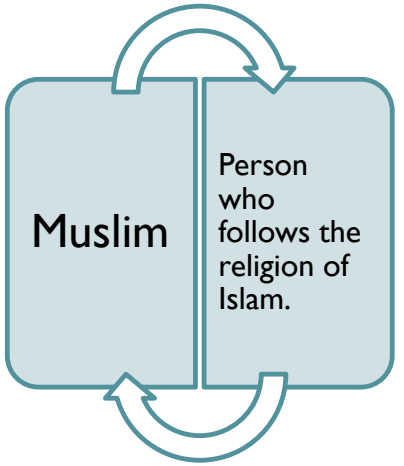
INTRODUCTION TO ISLAM

- Most religions are named after their founders or place of origin, but Islam is an exception.
- Christianity is named after Jesus Christ, Buddhism after Gautama Buddha, Zoroastrianism after Zoroaster, and Judaism after the tribe of Judah.
- Islam is not named after a person, community, or country, it is a universal religion.
- Islam means submission to the will of Allah and anyone who submits to Allah is considered a Muslim.

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WHAT DOES WORD ISLAM MEAN?

- The term Islam derives from the Arabic root letters (س – ل – م ، سَلَمَ) which meaning is “submission”, “surrender”, and “peace”.
- Islam means **Peace**, as it is derived from the word “Salam (سلامة)” peace.
- The word Islam means **Submission**, as its faithful surrender to the will of Allah SWT.



The name Islam was instituted by the Qur’an

اِنَّ الدِّيْنَ عِنْدَ اللّٰهِ الْاِسْلَامُ

(Surat Aal e Imran, verse:19)



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THE MEANING OF ISLAM

Submission to Allah in Islam brings personal peace through alignment with divine will and fosters social harmony by promoting justice and compassion in society.

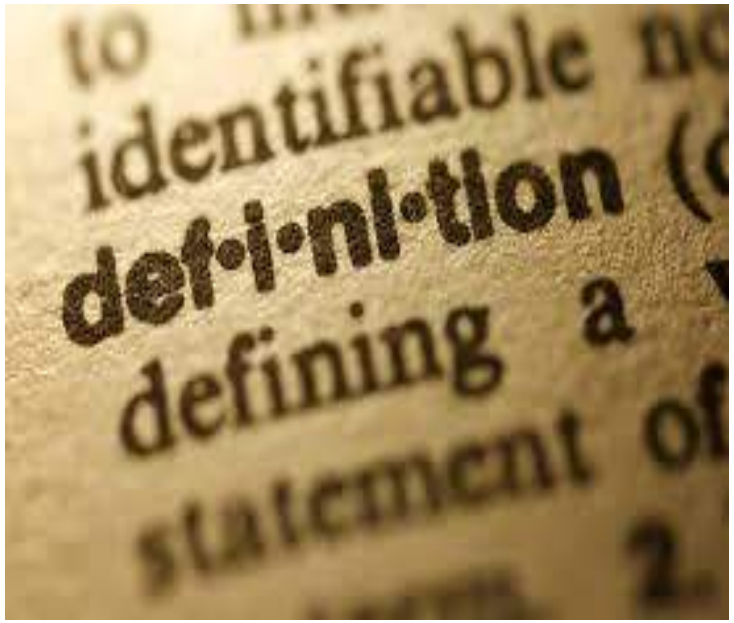
Meaning of Islam as 'Peace': One of the literal meanings of the word Islam is 'peace'. This indicates that true peace of body and mind can only be achieved through submission and obedience to Allah.

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DEFINITION OF ISLAM

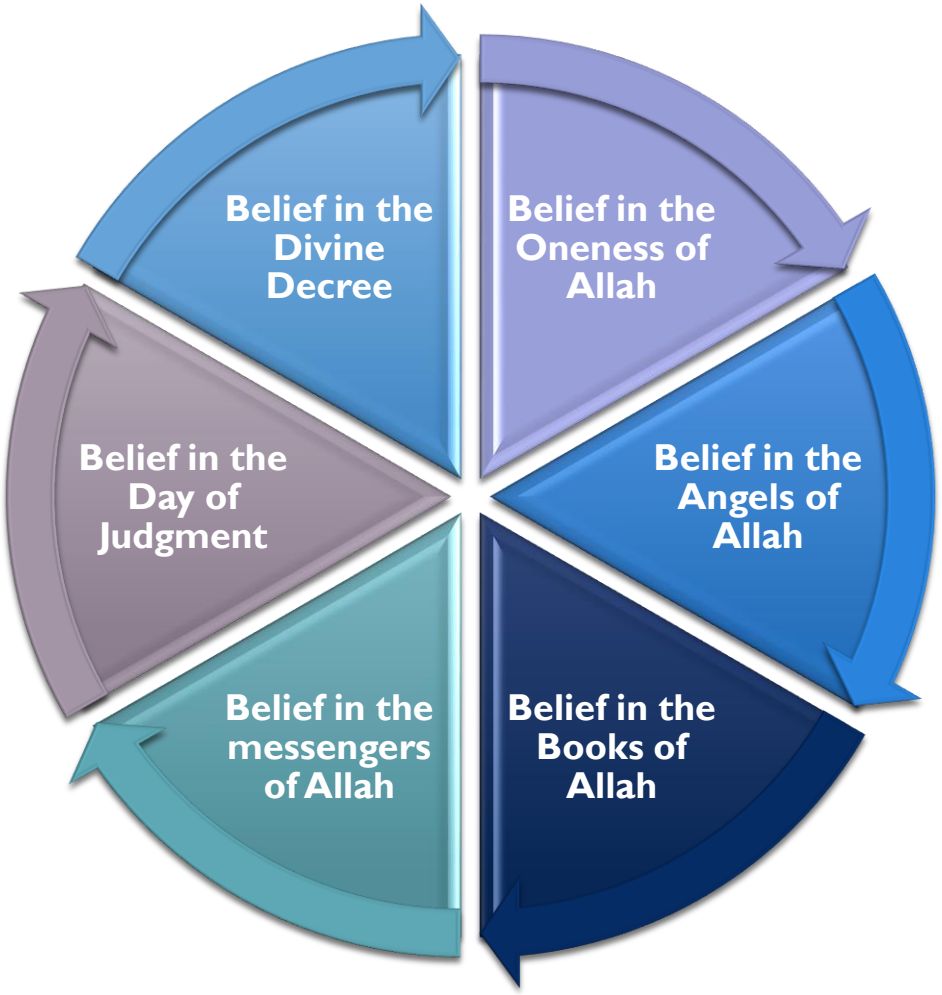
“Islam is the submission to the will of Allah and obedience to His law.”



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CORE BELIEFS



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CORE BELIEFS OF ISLAM

The core beliefs of Islam involves detailing the fundamental principles that guide the faith and practices of Muslims around the world. These beliefs form the foundation upon which all other aspects of Islam are built. Here's the core beliefs of Islam, we discuss through the Imaan e Mufssal.

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IMAN-E-MUFASSAL

اٰمَنْتُ بِاللّٰهِ وَمَلٰئِكَتِه وَكُتُبِه وَرُسُلِه وَالْيَوْمِ
الْاٰخِرِ وَالْقَدْرِ خَيْرِه وَشَرِّه مِنَ اللّٰهِ تَعَالٰى
وَالْبَعْثِ بَعْدَ الْمَوْتِ

I believe in Allah ﷻ, His Angels, His Books, His Messengers,
the Last Day, and in Taqdîr, that all good and bad is from Allah
ﷻ the Most High and I believe in the resurrection after death.
(Taqdîr: Predestination)

[Surah 2 Verse 177, Surah 54 Verse 49, Surah 4 Verse 136]

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ARTICLES OF FAITH IN IMAAN E MUFASAL

These are the articles explained in Imaan e Mufasal:

1. **Tawhid -** The belief in one Allah
2. **The Prophets of Allah -** Faith in all of His messengers or Prophets
3. **Holy Books** - Faith in His revealed Books
4. **Angels** - Faith in His angels
5. **The Day of Judgment -** Faith in the Last Day of Judgement
6. **The Supremacy of Allah's will** - Allah knows all and allows all to happen.
7. **Faith in the life after death**

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TAWHEED - BELIEF IN ALLAH

Allah (God): the unity and oneness of God (Allah) is called Tawhid. Muslims believe in one God. The Arabic word for God is Allah, which simply means "the (al) God (ilah)", (معبود). The opposite of Tawheed is Shirk.

Tawhid in Arabic means attributing Oneness to Allah. In Arabic "Wahid (وَاحد), Ahad (اَحد) and Wahid (وَحِيد), all meaning One. Allah is Wahid, meaning that He has no rivals or peers in any way. So Tawhid means knowing Allah is One, with none like unto Him. Whoever does not acknowledge Allah in these terms and does not describe Him as being One with no partner or associate does not believe in Tawhid. In Quran:

قُلْ هُوَ ٱللَّهُ أَحَدٌ (١) ٱللَّهُ ٱلصَّمَدُ (٢) لَمْ يَلِدْ وَلَمْ يُولَدْ (٣) وَلَمْ يَكُن لَّهُۥ كُفُوًا أَحَدٌۢ (٤)

"Say, He is Allah, the One and Only; Allah, the Eternal, Absolute; He begetteth not, nor is He begotten; And there is none like unto Him." [Quran 112:1–4]

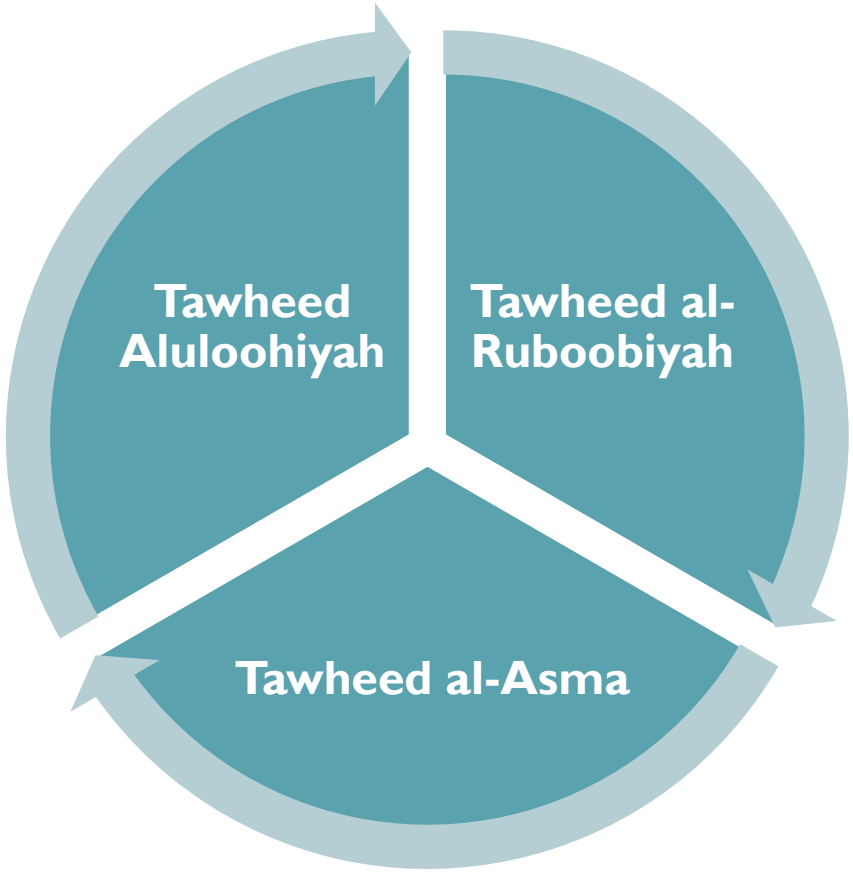
This verse emphasizes the uniqueness and oneness of God and rejects the notion of any partners or offspring for Allah. It is a concise statement of the Islamic belief in Tawhid.

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TYPES OF TAWHEED

Tawhid can be categorized into three types:

1. Tawhid al-Rububiyyah
2. Tawhid al-Uluhiyyah
3. Tawhid al-Asma wa Sifat



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Tawhid Ar-Rububiyyah (Oneness of Lordship)

توحید ربوبیت

This aspect of Tawhid emphasizes the oneness of Allah in His role as the Lord and Creator of the universe. It involves acknowledging that Allah is the sole originator, sustainer, and controller of all things.

Believers affirm that Allah is the only source of power, the only one with the authority to legislate, and the only one with the ability to create and maintain the universe.

Tawhid Rububiyyah serves as a foundation for understanding the divine wisdom behind creation and events in the world. It emphasizes that everything happens by the will and decree of Allah alone.

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TAWHID AL-ULUHIYYAH (ONENESS OF WORSHIP)

توحيد الالوهيت

This is the oneness of Allah with respect to Him being the only one who is an "ilaa (God, object of adoration and worship)". This aspect of Tawhid is concerned with the exclusive right of Allah to be worshiped. It involves directing all acts of worship, devotion, and obedience solely to Allah, without associating any partners with Him.

The concept of Tawhid al-Uluhiyyah rejects the worship of anything or anyone other than Allah, including idols, or any created beings. The primary Islamic creed, the Shahada, encapsulates this aspect by declaring the oneness of Allah and the exclusive worship of Him.

Shirk (associating partners with Allah) is considered the biggest sin in Islam, and avoiding it is central to maintaining Tawhid al-Uluhiyyah.

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TAWHID AL-ASMA' WA AL-SIFAT
(ONENESS OF GOD'S NAMES AND ATTRIBUTES)

توحيد الاسماء والصفات

Asma means name and Siffat means attributes. So its means to maintain the unity of Allah in its names and its sublime attributes. It is not allowed to give the title of Allah to the creation of Allah specially names and attributes.

Muslims believe that Allah's names and attributes are incomparable and unique, reflecting His perfection and absolute transcendence. They avoid making any resemblance between the Creator and His creation.

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BELIEF IN THE ANGELS OF ALLAH

Muslims believe in angels, unseen beings who worship Allah and carry out Allah's orders throughout the universe.

- ✓ Hazrat Jibril (AS) (Gabriel): Sends messages from Allah to prophets.
- ✓ Hazrat Mikail (AS) (Michael): Provides food and sustenance.
- ✓ Hazrat Israfil (AS): Will blow the trumpet on the Day of Judgment.
- ✓ Hazrat Izrail (AS) (Azrael): Takes the souls of the deceased.

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BELIEF IN THE BOOKS OF ALLAH

Muslims believe that Allah revealed holy books or scriptures to a number of Allah's messengers.

- Torah (Towrait) given to Hazrat Moosa (AS)
- Psalms (Zaboor) given to Hazrat Daud (AS)
- Gospel (Injeel) given to Hazrat Esa (AS)
- Quran given to Hazrat Muhammad (ﷺ)

Muslims believe that the Towrait, Zaboor, Injeel, and other scriptures were also revealed by Allah, but they were altered or corrupted over time and are not in their original form. We believe that the Quran is the final and unaltered revelation from Allah.

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BELIEF IN THE MESSENGERS OF ALLAH

Prophethood (عقیدہِ رسالت)

Risalah (prophethood):

Prophethood is not unknown to heavenly revealed religions, such as Judaism and Christianity. In Islam, however, it has a special status and significance.

According to Islam, Allah created man for a noble purpose to worship Him and lead a virtuous life based on His teachings and guidance. How would man know his role and the purpose of his existence unless he received clear and practical instructions of what Allah wants him to do? Here comes the need for prophethood. Thus Allah has chosen from every nation at least one prophet to convey His Message to people.

- Prophets were people chosen particularly by Allah. Prophethood is a divine gift that could not be acquired through intellectual or physical capability.

ذَٰلِكَ فَضْلُ ٱللَّهِ يُؤْتِيهِ مَن يَشَآءُ ۚ وَٱللَّهُ ذُو ٱلْفَضْلِ ٱلْعَظِيمِ ٤

"This is the favor of Allah. He grants it to whoever He wills. And Allah is the Lord of infinite bounty." **(62:4)**

- There are two types of prophets: Nabis are any Prophet. Nabi and Rasool who have received a book. As "Seal" of the Prophets, Prophet Muhammadﷺ was sent to all mankind. He is considered the last and greatest Nabi and Rasool.

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- Belief in all the Prophets of Allah. Though the Quran mentions that some were preferred by Allah over others, Muslim must believe in all of them those named in the Quran and those who weren't and respect them all.

  "We make no distinction between one and other of them" (3:84)

- All Prophets spoke the language of their people

وَمَآ أَرۡسَلۡنَا مِن رَّسُولٍ إِلَّا بِلِسَانِ قَوۡمِهِۦ لِيُبَيِّنَ لَهُمۡۖ فَيُضِلُّ ٱللَّهُ مَن يَشَآءُ وَيَهۡدِي مَن يَشَآءُۚ وَهُوَ ٱلۡعَزِيزُ ٱلۡحَكِيمُ ٤

"We have not sent a messenger except in the language of his people to clarify ˹the message˺ for them. Then Allah leaves whoever He wills to stray and guides whoever He wills. And He is the Almighty, All-Wise." **(14:4)**

- It was mandatory for the Prophet's followers to obey them. However, people still rejected and persecuted them.

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PURPOSE OF PROPHETHOOD

Here are some points highlighting the purpose of Prophet hood:

Divine Guidance: Prophets are chosen by a higher power to deliver divine guidance and teachings to humanity, providing a roadmap for righteous living and spiritual fulfillment.

Divine Mercy: Prophets are a manifestation of divine mercy and compassion, as they strive to guide humanity towards salvation and enlightenment, despite human frailty and shortcomings.



Role Models: Prophets serve as exemplars of virtue and righteousness, demonstrating through their lives and actions the principles they preach, thereby inspiring others to follow suit.

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Establishing Moral and Ethical Principles: Prophets establish moral and ethical principles that form the foundation of a just and harmonious society, guiding individuals and communities in their interactions and behaviors.

Warning and Guidance: Prophets warn of the consequences of disobedience and offer guidance on how to attain salvation or avoid divine punishment, urging people to repent and seek forgiveness.

Reviving Faith: Prophets revive faith in the hearts of believers, rejuvenating spiritual practices, renewing commitment to God, and revitalizing communities through their teachings and example.

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THE FINALITY OF PROPHET-HOOD

- عن بن عباس عن النبي صلى الله عليه وسلم قال أنا أحمد ومحمد والحاشر والمقفي والخاتم

Translation: Hadrat Ibn Abbas (ra) narrates that the Prophet (Peace be upon him) said: I am Ahmed, Muhammad, Hashir, Maqfi (One who is sent in the last) and I am “KHATIM”

[Imam Tabarani in Muj’am as Saghir, Hadith # 152]

- وأنا خاتم النبيين لا نبي بعدي

“And I am the last of the Prophets, there is no Prophet after me."



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HEREAFTER - AL-AKHIRAH (عقیدہِ آخرت)

- The Arabic word (الآخرة) Al-Akhirah, is an Islamic term referring to the life after death (hereafter or afterlife). It is derived from the root word Al-Akhir which means the last, the ultimate, the end or close.
- Akhirah (the afterlife) Belief in the final judgement and life after death. This life is a preparation for the eternal life that follows. On the last day there will be a time of judgement, when Muslims will have to account for their lives.
- **Accountability and judgment:** A central tenet of Akhirah is the concept of accountability. Muslims believe that every individual will be judged based on their deeds, determining their fate in the hereafter.

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BELIEF IN THE DAY OF JUDGMENT

Muslims believe that on the Day of Judgment, humans will be judged for their actions in this life, those who followed Allah’s guidance will be rewarded with paradise, those who rejected Allah’s guidance will be punished with hell.

BELIEF IN THE DIVINE DECREE

Belief in the Divine Decree means accepting that everything happens according to Allah's plan. It means believing that both good and bad events are part of a predetermined plan, and that we should respond to them with gratitude or patience. This belief doesn't mean we don't have free will, we can still make choices, but we don't know what Allah has planned, so we must choose wisely.

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